HTML Notes: Chapter 2 – Text

Headings, paragraphs, emphasis, structural and semantic markup

Basics

- Markup = tags added to page content. They give extra meaning and let browsers show the right structure.
- **Structural markup**: headings and paragraphs.
- **Semantic markup**: adds meaning (emphasis, quotes, acronyms, etc.).

Headings `<h1>–<h6>`

- `<h1>` = main heading (largest), `<h2>` = subheading, `<h3>` = sub-sections, down to `<h6>` (smallest).
- Exact sizes vary by browser. Users can resize text. Size, colour and font are controlled with CSS.

HTML

```
<h1>This is a Main Heading</h1>
<h2>This is a Level 2 Heading</h2>
<h3>This is a Level 3 Heading</h3>
<h4>This is a Level 4 Heading</h4>
<h5>This is a Level 5 Heading</h5>
<h6>This is a Level 6 Heading</h6>
```

RESULT

<h1>This is a Main Heading</h1>
<h2>This is a Level 2 Heading</h2>
<h3>This is a Level 3 Heading</h3>
<h4>This is a Level 4 Heading</h4>
<h5>This is a Level 5 Heading</h5>
<h6>This is a Level 6 Heading</h6>

Paragraphs `<p>`

- Wrap text in `<p>...</p>`.
- Browsers put each paragraph on a new line with space between them.

HTML

```
<p>A paragraph consists of one
or more sentences.</p>
<p>Text is easier to understand
when split into units.</p>
```

RESULT

A paragraph consists of one or more sentences.

Text is easier to understand when split into units.

Bold & italic (visual only)

- `<b>` = bold. Used for key words, but adds no extra meaning.
- `<i>` = italic. Used for technical terms, ship names, foreign words, thoughts.

HTML

```
<p>Some <b>key features</b> in bold.</p>
<p>It's a potato
  <i>Solanum teberosum</i>.</p>
<p>Cook sailed on the
  <i>Endeavour</i>.</p>
```

RESULT

Some **key features** in bold.

It's a potato *Solanum teberosum*.

Cook sailed on the *Endeavour*.

Strong & emphasis (semantic)

- `<strong>` = strong importance, shown bold (e.g. warnings).
- `<em>` = emphasis that subtly changes the meaning of a sentence, shown italic.
- Moving `<em>` changes the meaning.

HTML

```
<p><strong>Beware:</strong> Pickpockets
  operate here.</p>
<p>I <em>think</em> Ivy was first.</p>
<p>I think <em>Ivy</em> was first.</p>
<p>I think Ivy was the <em>first</em>.</p>
```

RESULT

Beware: Pickpockets operate here.

I *think* Ivy was first.

I think *Ivy* was first.

I think Ivy was the *first*.

Superscript & subscript

- `<sup>` = raised text: date suffixes, powers.
- `<sub>` = lowered text: footnotes, chemical formulas.

HTML

```
<p>On the 4<sup>th</sup> of September
  you learn E=MC<sup>2</sup>.</p>
<p>CO<sub>2</sub> in the atmosphere.</p>
```

RESULT

On the 4^{th} of September you learn $E=MC^2$.
CO_2 in the atmosphere.

White space

- The browser collapses multiple spaces and line breaks into one space (**white space collapsing**).
- So you can indent and spread code over lines for readability without changing the output.

HTML

```
<p>The moon is drifting away.</p>
<p>The moon        is drifting
  away.</p>
<p>The moon is

   drifting away.</p>
```

RESULT

The moon is drifting away.
The moon is drifting away.
The moon is drifting away.

Line breaks & horizontal rules

- `<br />` = line break inside a paragraph.
- `<hr />` = horizontal line between sections or themes.
- Both are **empty elements**: no closing tag, no content. Written with a space and slash before > (good habit).

HTML

```
<p>The Earth<br />gets heavier<br />every
day.</p>

<p>Venus rotates clockwise.</p>
<hr />
<p>Jupiter is the biggest.</p>
```

RESULT

The Earth
gets heavier
every day.
Venus rotates clockwise.

Jupiter is the biggest.

Quotations

- `<blockquote>` = long quote, takes a whole paragraph. A `<p>` still goes inside it. Browsers indent it, but don't use it just to indent (use CSS).
- `<q>` = short inline quote. Browsers add quote marks (old IE didn't).
- Both can use a `cite` attribute = URL of the source.

HTML

```
<blockquote cite="http://...">
  <p>Did you ever stop to
  think, and forget to
  start again?</p>
</blockquote>
<p>As Milne said, <q>Some
  people talk to animals.</q></p>
```

RESULT

Did you ever stop to think, and forget to start again?
As Milne said, "Some people talk to animals."

Abbreviations & acronyms

- `<abbr>`: the **title** attribute holds the full term (shown on hover).
- HTML 4 had a separate `<acronym>`. HTML5 uses `<abbr>` for both.

HTML

```
<p><abbr title="Professor">Prof</abbr>
  Hawking is a physicist.</p>
<p><abbr title="National
  Aeronautics and Space
  Administration">NASA</abbr>
  does space stuff.</p>
```

RESULT

Prof Hawking is a physicist.
NASA does space stuff.
[hover on NASA shows: National Aeronautics and Space Administration]

Citations & definitions

- `<cite>` = reference to a work (book, film, paper), shown in italics. In HTML5, not meant for a person's name.
- `<dfn>` = the defining instance of a new term (first time you explain it). Some browsers italicise it; Safari and Chrome don't.

HTML

```
<p><cite>A Brief History of
  Time</cite> by Stephen
  Hawking sold 10 million.</p>
<p>A <dfn>black hole</dfn> is a
  region of space from which
  nothing can escape.</p>
```

RESULT

A Brief History of Time by Stephen Hawking sold 10 million.

A black hole is a region of space from which nothing can escape.

Author details

- `<address>` = contact details for the page author (physical address, phone or email).
- Often shown in italics. Can contain `<a href="mailto:...">` for email links.

HTML

```
<address>
  <p><a href="mailto:
  homer@example.org">
  homer@example.org</a></p>
  <p>742 Evergreen Terrace,
  Springfield.</p>
</address>
```

RESULT

homer@example.org
742 Evergreen Terrace, Springfield.

Changes to content

- `<ins>` = inserted text (usually underlined).
- `<del>` = deleted text (usually struck through).
- `<s>` = no longer accurate/relevant but shouldn't be deleted (e.g. old price).
- `<u>` (underline) is old and being phased out.

HTML

```
<p>It was the <del>worst</del>
  <ins>best</ins> idea.</p>
<p>Laptop computer:</p>
<p><s>Was $995</s></p>
<p>Now only $375</p>
```

RESULT

It was the ~~worst~~ best idea.

Laptop computer:

~~Was $995~~

Now only $375

Quick cheat sheet

Tag	Use
`<h1>–<h6>`	Headings
`<p>`	Paragraph
`<b> / <i>`	Bold / italic (visual)
`<strong> / <em>`	Important / emphasis (semantic)
`<sup> / <sub>`	Super / subscript
`  / <hr />`	Line break / horizontal rule
`<blockquote> / <q>`	Long / short quote
`<abbr>`	Abbreviation (with title)
`<cite> / <dfn>`	Citation / definition
`<address>`	Author contact info
`<ins> / <del> / <s>`	Inserted / deleted / no longer relevant